Try This Monday

Four AI prompts for small business owners. No code required.

NCVETBIZ PROCUREMENT SUMMIT
OCTOBER 26, 2026

Copy a prompt into the AI tool you already have (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Microsoft Copilot), replace the **[brackets]**, and paste your material at the end. Start with one prompt this week. Read every answer before you use it.

1. Bid / No-Bid Memo

Use when a public solicitation lands and you need to decide fast whether it is worth your time.

```
You are a proposal manager for a small veteran-owned business.
About my business: [two sentences on what you do and for whom].
Read the solicitation below, then:
1. Summarize what the buyer needs in three sentences.
2. List every compliance requirement (due date, submission format, page limits,
   required forms, certifications, insurance) in a table with the section reference.
3. List the evaluation criteria and how they are weighted, if stated.
4. List what the document does NOT tell us, with the question I should ask the buyer.
5. Recommend: proceed, proceed with caution, or pause. Give three reasons.
Do not invent facts, prices, or qualifications that are not in the document.
Solicitation: [paste text]
```

2. Event Scorer

Use when there are more networking events than Saturdays.

```
My ideal client: [one paragraph: who they are, company size, the problem I solve].
Clients I should avoid: [no budget, wants it free, wrong industry, etc.].
Score each event below from 0 to 100 for how likely I am to meet my ideal client
there. Consider who attends, the topic, the cost, and whether I could speak or
exhibit. Return a table sorted by score with a one-sentence reason for each, and
flag any event that mostly attracts the clients I should avoid.
Events: [paste names, dates, descriptions, and links]
```

3. Follow-Up Drafter

Use right after a meeting, while it is fresh. Remove personal details before you paste.

```
Turn my rough meeting notes into a follow-up email from me to [first name].
Keep it under 150 words, warm and direct. Restate the two or three things we
agreed on and name the next step with a date. Do not promise anything that is
not in my notes. After the email, list anything in my notes that sounds like a
commitment I should double-check before sending.
Notes: [paste]
```

4. Write the Process Down

Use on any task you repeat every week. This is how a prompt becomes a system.

```
I do this task about [number] times a week: [describe the task].
Interview me one question at a time to capture the exact steps, the inputs I
need, the decisions I make, and what "done" looks like. When we finish, give me
a numbered checklist and mark which steps a tool could do for me and which ones
need my judgment.
```

Six Guardrails

From a Marine and cybersecurity professional who uses AI every day.

ALN LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT & COACHING

1. **Protect client data.** Free consumer AI plans may use what you paste to improve their models. For client work, use a business plan with data protections turned on, or strip names, emails, and personal details before you paste.
2. **Make it show its sources.** Ask what the answer is based on, and what it does not know. "Not stated in the document" is a good answer.
3. **A human sends it.** Anything that leaves your business (emails, proposals, invoices) gets a person's eyes first.
4. **Never let it invent credentials.** Past performance, certifications, prices, and dates come from you, not the model.
5. **Get a second opinion.** For work that matters, have a second AI from a different company check the first one's output. We build with one and verify with another, so we never depend on a single vendor, and disagreements show us exactly where to look closer.
6. **Start with one annoying task.** Not an AI strategy. One task. When it works, pick the next one.

The rule under everything: AI drafts. The owner approves. Approved work stays locked.

Your ideal client, in four lines

Who buys from me? (title, company size)

What problem keeps them up at night?

Where do they gather? (associations, chambers, summits)

Who should I avoid? (red flags)

That paragraph is the most valuable AI prompt you own. Paste it at the top of prompts 1 and 2.

Your first automation candidate

The task I repeat every week that I would happily never do again:

Paul Navarro · Co-Founder, ALN Leadership Development & Coaching
paul.navarro@alnleadership.com · 919-213-1502 · alnleadership.com
Service-disabled veteran-owned small business. Built on Service. Driven by Science.